

- 4 There are plenty of review videos on Youtube so you can check them out to decide which controller would suit you the best.

Optical disk drives

Optical disk drives have been losing popularity for quite some time quite simply due to the fact that flash memory has become a lot more cheaper and the rewrite capability, the transfer speeds and the convenience of USB. However, we are not going to see the demise of the optical disk drive yet.



Types

There are over 20 types of optical disks in use this day apart from the very popular CD + DVD + Blu-Ray combo but we'll focus on just these three since that's pretty much all that we'll be seeing when dealing with computers.

CD

The compact disc has been around for quite some time and isn't quite frequently used these days owing to its low capacity. Nevertheless, we can still find audio CDs and low cost video CDs on the market and that is not going to change for some time. The average CD comes in multiple formats, some can be written only once or as it is called in optical terminology, "burned" once. Then there are re-recordable ones that are good for about 25 write cycles. Burning is the process in which the CDs are actually burned with a laser so as to create miniscule dots and dashes. These dots and dashes are binary code for data. CDs are limited to 700 MBs of storage capacity.

DVD

The Digital Versatile Disc came forth as the successor to the CD bringing for much greater capacities. This is due to the fact that you now have dual-layer DVDs and double-sided DVDs. So capacities range from 4.7 GB to 17.08 GB on the double-sided dual-layer DVDs. Though CDs, DVDs and Blu-Ray are all equal in diameter the density of data is not the same and this is why with every new generation of optical medium that we get to see greater capacities.